

ALEXANDRA CHEN

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven software engineer with 8+ years of experience designing and building scalable distributed systems. Passionate about clean architecture, developer experience, and mentoring teams. Led initiatives that improved system reliability by 99.95% and reduced deployment times by 60%. Seeking to leverage deep technical expertise in a Staff Engineer role.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer — [Stripe](#)

San Francisco, CA • Jan 2021 – Present

- Architected and led the migration of a monolithic payment processing service to a microservices architecture, reducing latency by 40% and enabling independent scaling.
- Designed a real-time fraud detection pipeline processing 50M+ transactions daily using Kafka, Flink, and custom ML models, reducing chargebacks by 23%.
- Mentored a team of 6 engineers, establishing code review standards and leading weekly architecture deep-dives that improved team velocity by 35%.
- Implemented comprehensive observability with distributed tracing (Jaeger) and custom Grafana dashboards, cutting mean-time-to-resolution by 50%.

Software Engineer II — [Airbnb](#)

San Francisco, CA • Mar 2018 – Dec 2020

- Built the dynamic pricing recommendation engine serving 100K+ hosts, increasing average booking revenue by 18% through machine-learning-driven suggestions.
- Developed a GraphQL federation layer unifying 12 backend services, improving frontend development speed and reducing API response times by 30%.
- Led the adoption of container orchestration (Kubernetes) for 40+ microservices, reducing infrastructure costs by 25% through auto-scaling policies.

Software Engineer — [Palantir Technologies](#)

Palo Alto, CA • Jun 2016 – Feb 2018

- Developed data integration pipelines for government analytics platforms handling 2TB+ of daily data ingestion with 99.9% uptime SLA.
 - Created an internal developer toolkit that reduced onboarding time for new engineers from 3 weeks to 5 days.
 - Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver a real-time threat intelligence dashboard used by 500+ analysts daily.
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EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Science — Stanford University

2014 – 2016 • Focus: Distributed Systems & Machine Learning | GPA: 3.92/4.0

B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics — University of California, Berkeley

2010 – 2014 • Magna Cum Laude | GPA: 3.88/4.0

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages:	Python • Go • Java • TypeScript • Rust • SQL
Infrastructure:	Kubernetes • Docker • Terraform • AWS • GCP • CI/CD
Data & ML:	Kafka • Spark • Flink • PostgreSQL • Redis • TensorFlow
Practices:	Microservices • System Design • TDD • Agile/Scrum • Tech Lead

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Solutions Architect – Professional (2023)
 - Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) (2022)
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OPEN SOURCE PROJECTS

OpenTrace

Open-source distributed tracing library for Go microservices. 2.5K+ GitHub stars, adopted by 3 companies in production.